

DEPART TRAVEL SERVICES

DEPART TRAVEL SERVICES · TUNISIA

TUNISIA

Community-based & modular journeys — prepared for Village Adventures

WHO WE ARE

Depart Travel Services is a licensed Tunisian Destination Management Company (DMC) based in Djerba. We design and operate ground experiences across the whole country, from the Mediterranean medinas of the north to the Berber south and the edge of the Sahara.

We work with our own insured fleet, ONTT-certified local guides, and a 24/7 support desk. Crucially for a modern booking platform, we supply both fully packaged tours **and** modular building blocks: standalone day tours, short multi-day modules, point-to-point transfers, and à-la-carte accommodation. Whatever the traveller's plan, we can drop our products into it cleanly.

We are a community-rooted operator: roughly 95% of the accommodation we use is locally owned, around 90% of meals are sourced from locally-owned kitchens, and we pay artisans and rural hosts fairly and directly. Our welfare standards are ABTA-aligned (camel riding is always optional), we use reusable water, and we can supply CO₂e-per-night figures, eCollective-ready.

WHY DEPART TRAVEL — FOR VILLAGE ADVENTURES

We have read Village Adventures' positioning closely, and Tunisia fits it precisely.

- **Modular building blocks for independent travellers.** Our catalogue is already broken into bookable day tours and short 2–5 day modules. They slot into a traveller's own itinerary rather than locking them into a fixed group programme — exactly the format a platform of independent travellers needs.
- **Platform-friendly content.** Each block has a clear region, duration, and activity description. We can supply structured module content and feeds for your platform, so listing Tunisia is fast and the information shown to your customers is accurate.
- **Rural community-based tourism at the core.** Our Berber South & Sahara product runs through the CBT heartland — troglodyte villages, oasis communities, and desert families who host travellers directly.
- **Homestays & eco-lodges.** We use a restored troglodyte guesthouse in Tijma, homestay-style local *dars*, oasis and island guesthouses, and an eco-minded desert camp (Dunes Insolites) — not anonymous resort blocks.
- **Nature & beyond the beach.** Mountain oases, canyons, salt lakes, Saharan dunes, and Roman ruins free of crowds. This is the Tunisia that sits beyond "just the beach," which is exactly where you want to take your community.
- **Built for the German market.** Precise, reliable, well-documented information; punctual logistics; clear pricing; a costed reply within 72 hours. We know German travellers value accuracy and dependability, and we deliver both.

WHY TUNISIA FOR YOUR COMMUNITY

Tunisia is compact enough to combine wildly different landscapes in a single short trip, yet still genuinely off the mass-tourism radar inland. Within a few hours of Djerba a traveller can move from palm-shaded mountain oases and dramatic canyons (Chebika, Tamerza, Midès) to the vast salt flats of Chott el Jerid and the dunes of the Sahara.

Threaded through that nature is living Amazigh (Berber) culture: troglodyte homes carved into the hills of Matmata and Tamezret, fortified granaries (ksour), oasis farming communities, and craft traditions like Guellala pottery. Travellers don't observe these communities from a coach window — they stay in their guesthouses, share their meals, and buy directly from their makers.

For a platform built on nature and community-based tourism, Tunisia offers a rare combination: authentic rural encounters, world-class landscapes, and short flight times from Germany — all in a destination most of your community has never considered.

MODULAR BUILDING BLOCKS

Bookable Day Tours

Tour	Region	Approx. duration	What travellers do
Tunis Medina & Bardo Museum	Tunis (North)	Full day	Explore the UNESCO medina and the Bardo's world-class Roman mosaics
Carthage & Sidi Bou Saïd	Tunis (North)	Full day	Ancient Punic/Roman Carthage, then the blue-and-white clifftop village
Dougga Roman City	North-west	Full day	Wander one of North Africa's best-preserved Roman cities, crowd-free
Kairouan	Central	Full day	The Great Mosque and holy city, carpet and craft workshops
Mountain Oases & Canyons 4x4	South-west (Tozeur)	Full day	4x4 to Chebika, Tamerza and Midès oases and gorges
Chott el Jerid + Sahara Camel & Camp	South-west	Full day / overnight	Cross the salt lake, optional camel trek, overnight in a desert camp
Matmata & Tamezret Troglodyte Villages	South	Full day	Visit underground Berber homes and a Berber family home
Djerba Discovery	Djerba (Island)	Full day	El Ghriba synagogue, Guellala pottery, Djerbahood street art
El Jem Amphitheatre	Central-east	Half / full day	Stand inside one of the largest Roman amphitheatres anywhere
Sousse Medina	East coast	Half / full day	UNESCO medina, ribat and kasbah of the old port city

Short Multi-Day Modules (2-5 days)

Module	Region	Duration	Focus
Rural Berber & Sahara CBT	South & South-west	~5 days	Troglodyte stays, Berber communities, dunes and desert camp
Oases & Canyons of the South-west	Tozeur / Nefta	2–3 days	Mountain oases, gorges, Chott el Jerid, palm groves
Sahara Camel & Camp Escape	South-west	2 days	Camel trek and night under canvas at an eco-minded camp
Roman Tunisia	North & central	3 days	Carthage, Dougga, El Jem and Bardo mosaics
Djerba & Southern Gateway	Djerba & South	3 days	Island crafts and culture, then a short hop into the Berber south

Sample Itineraries

Rural Berber & Sahara CBT — ~5 Days

Overview. A compact community-based module built for independent travellers who want the essence of the Berber south and the Sahara without committing to a long fixed tour. It slots neatly onto either end of a Djerba stay and leans entirely on locally-owned guesthouses and hosts.

Key Information.

- Duration: 5 days / 4 nights
- Start / end: Djerba (flexible; transfers à la carte)
- Group size: guaranteed from 2 pax
- Style: rural CBT, homestays & eco-lodge, light walking, optional camel
- Pace: relaxed, independent-friendly

Highlights.

- Troglodyte villages of Matmata and Tamezret with a Berber family home visit
- Overnight in a restored troglodyte guesthouse
- Mountain oases and canyons of Chebika, Tamerza and Midès by 4x4
- Chott el Jerid salt lake crossing and a night at an eco-minded desert camp
- Direct contact with rural hosts and artisans throughout

Day-by-Day Itinerary.

Day 1: Djerba to the Berber Hills

Leave the island and head inland into the Dahar plateau, where the landscape turns from coast to rugged stone hills. The afternoon is spent exploring fortified granaries (ksour) and settling into a restored troglodyte guesthouse, sharing an evening meal cooked by your hosts.



Accommodation: Restored troglodyte guesthouse (Tijma) · *Meals:* Dinner

Day 2: Matmata & Tamezret Troglodyte Villages

A full day among the underground Berber homes of Matmata and the hilltop village of Tamezret, including a welcome into a Berber family home for tea and conversation. You'll understand how these communities live with the heat and the land, and meet the people directly rather than passing through.



Accommodation: Local *dar* (homestay-style) · *Meals:* Breakfast, lunch

Day 3: Mountain Oases & Canyons by 4x4

Travel west toward Tozeur and spend the day by 4x4 in the mountain oases of Chebika, Tamerza and Midès — palm-filled gorges, waterfalls and dramatic canyon walls on the old Algerian frontier. There is time to walk and to swim in a natural oasis pool.



Accommodation: Oasis guesthouse · *Meals:* Breakfast, dinner

Day 4: Chott el Jerid & the Sahara

Cross the shimmering salt flats of Chott el Jerid to reach the edge of the dunes. An optional camel trek (always your choice) leads to an eco-minded desert camp, where the evening brings local music around the fire under a sky full of stars.



Accommodation: Eco-minded desert camp (Dunes Insolites) · *Meals:* Breakfast, dinner

Day 5: Desert Sunrise & Return

Wake to sunrise over the dunes before a relaxed breakfast at camp. The day is given to the journey back toward Djerba, with stops to stretch your legs and a final glimpse of the gorge country behind you.



Accommodation: — · *Meals:* Breakfast

Berber South & Sahara — 8-9 Days

Overview. Our flagship rural CBT journey, threading the full arc of the Berber south: troglodyte villages, fortified granaries, oasis communities, salt lakes and the Sahara. It can run as a complete tour or be split into the shorter modules above for platform listings.

Key Information.

- Duration: 8–9 days / 7–8 nights
- Start / end: Djerba or Tunis (flexible)
- Group size: guaranteed from 2 pax
- Style: rural community-based tourism, homestays, eco-lodge, light walking, optional camel
- Land-only net rates; no compulsory single supplement

Highlights.

- The fortified granary of Ksar Hadada and the ksour of the Dahar
- Matmata and Tamezret troglodyte villages and a Berber family home
- Chebika, Tamerza and Midès mountain oases and canyons
- Chott el Jerid salt lake and a Sahara desert camp
- Tozeur's old town and palm groves, plus Kairouan's holy city on the return

Day-by-Day Itinerary.

Day 1: Arrival & Djerba

Arrive on the island of Djerba and settle in. The afternoon introduces the island's gentle character — the El Ghriba synagogue, the potters of Guellala and the colourful street art of Djerbahood — before an evening meal at a locally-owned table.



Accommodation: Island guesthouse · *Meals:* Dinner

Day 2: Into the Ksour Country

Cross to the mainland and climb into the Dahar plateau, home to the south's dramatic fortified granaries. Explore the layered courtyards of Ksar Hadada and meet the communities who still tend these structures, then settle into a restored troglodyte guesthouse.



Accommodation: Restored troglodyte guesthouse (Tijma) · *Meals:* Breakfast, dinner

Day 3: Matmata & Tamezret

A full day among the underground Berber homes of Matmata and the hilltop village of Tamezret, including a visit to a Berber family home. You'll learn how the land shapes daily life here and spend time with hosts and craftspeople.



Accommodation: Local *dar* (homestay-style) · *Meals:* Breakfast, lunch

Day 4: To the Oases of the South-west

Travel west across changing country toward Tozeur, the great oasis town on the edge of the Sahara. The afternoon is spent walking the labyrinthine old town and the vast palm grove, with time to relax by an oasis pool.



Accommodation: Oasis guesthouse · *Meals:* Breakfast, dinner

Day 5: Mountain Oases & Canyons 4x4

By 4x4 into the mountains for Chebika, Tamerza and Midès — palm gorges, waterfalls and sheer canyon walls. There's time to walk the trails and take in the silence of these frontier oases.



Accommodation: Oasis guesthouse · *Meals:* Breakfast, dinner

Day 6: Chott el Jerid & the Sahara

Cross the immense salt flats of Chott el Jerid to reach the dunes. An optional camel trek (always your choice) carries you to an eco-minded desert camp for an evening of local music and a night under the stars.



Accommodation: Eco-minded desert camp (Dunes Insolites) · *Meals:* Breakfast, dinner

Day 7: Desert Morning & Tamerza Palace Country

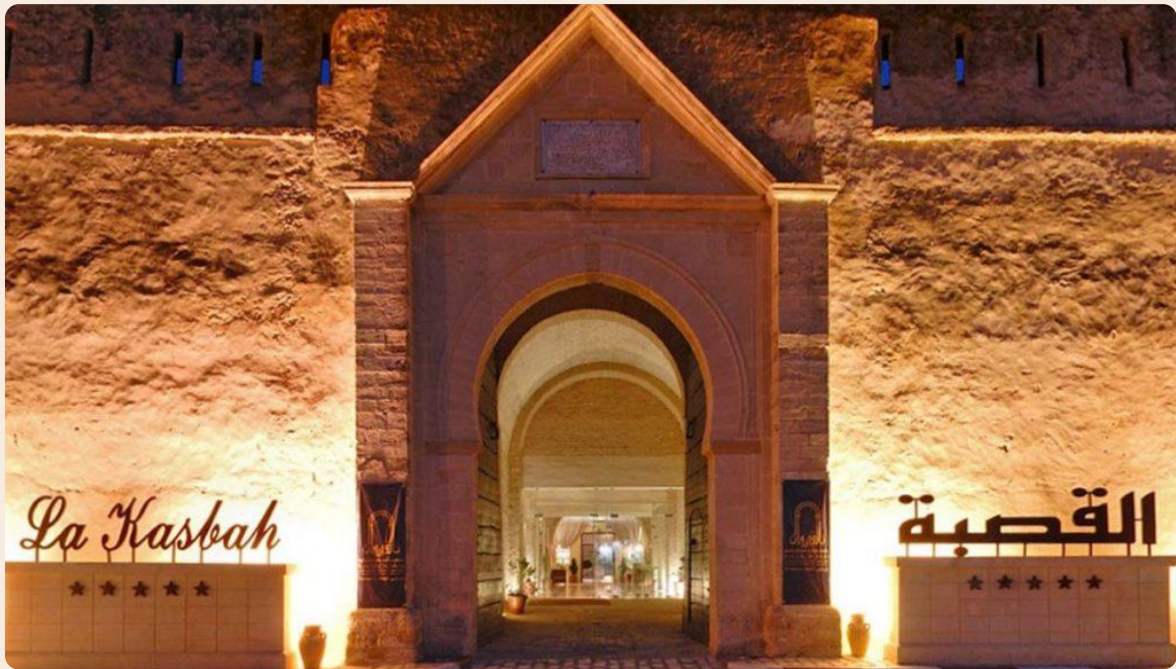
Sunrise over the dunes, then a gradual return through the dramatic oasis-and-canyon landscapes of the south-west, with stops to take in the views and the palm-fringed valleys before reaching your overnight base.



Accommodation: Oasis guesthouse · *Meals:* Breakfast, dinner

Day 8: Kairouan on the Way North

Journey toward Kairouan, Tunisia's holy city, to walk the Great Mosque and the medina and meet carpet and craft workshops. From here you continue to your departure point, or extend with our Roman or coastal modules.



Accommodation: Guesthouse · *Meals:* Breakfast

COMMUNITY-BASED & RESPONSIBLE TRAVEL

Community-based tourism is not a label we added on — it is how this product is built.

- **Locally owned.** Roughly 95% of the accommodation we use and about 90% of the meals served are from locally-owned businesses, keeping the value of each booking in the communities your travellers visit.
- **Fair, direct pay.** Artisans and rural hosts are paid fairly and directly, not through layers of intermediaries.
- **Animal welfare.** Our standards are ABTA-aligned; camel riding is always optional and never required to enjoy the experience.
- **Environment.** We use reusable water, favour eco-minded accommodation such as the Dunes Insolites camp, and can supply CO₂e-per-night figures — we are eCollective-ready for carbon reporting on your platform.
- **Genuine encounters.** Homestays, troglodyte guesthouses and family-home visits mean travellers meet communities as guests, not spectators.

PRICING

All rates are **land-only net rates**, with **no compulsory single supplement** and departures **guaranteed from 2 pax** — ideal for FIT, independent and modular bookings.

- **Multi-day journeys (illustrative):** our 8-day programmes run approximately **€931–1,770 per person**, land-only, depending on season, accommodation grade and group size.
- **Day tours & modules:** quoted **per service**, so they can be listed individually or bundled into a traveller's own itinerary.
- **Transfers & accommodation:** bookable **à la carte**.

These figures are illustrative; we will return a precise, costed quotation tailored to your platform and audience.

🕒 A costed response within 72 hours — guaranteed.

LET'S ADD TUNISIA TO YOUR PLATFORM

Isabel, thank you for the time on the fam trip — Tunisia is exactly the kind of nature-and-community destination Village Adventures was built to champion, and we would love to be your partner on the ground.

Here is how we can move quickly:

1. **Pick the building blocks.** Tell us which day tours and short modules fit your launch, and we'll prioritise those.
2. **We supply the content.** We'll provide structured module content, descriptions, durations and imagery — and we can deliver feeds so listings stay accurate on your platform.
3. **We quote.** You'll have net rates and a costed proposal within 72 hours.
4. **We pilot.** Start with a focused Tunisia set (the Rural Berber & Sahara CBT module is the natural lead) and grow from there.

Get in touch:

- Email: direction@depart-travel-services.com
- Phone / WhatsApp: +216 25 099 589
- Web: <https://depart-travel-services.com/fr/>

🕒 A costed response within 72 hours — guaranteed.